

# Copywriting Portfolio

*Three original samples across content marketing, direct response, and brand storytelling.*

# Sample 1: SEO Content Marketing Article

## Why You're Tired All the Time (And It's Probably Not Your Sleep)

You slept eight hours. You still feel like you're wading through wet sand by 2pm. If this is a familiar feeling, you've probably already tried the obvious fixes. More sleep. Less caffeine. An earlier bedtime that lasted about four days before real life got in the way. And yet the exhaustion is still there, sitting on your chest like it pays rent.

Here's something worth considering. Fatigue and sleepiness are not always the same problem, even though we talk about them like they are. Sleepiness is your body asking for rest. Fatigue is often your body asking for something else entirely, and sleep just happens to be the thing we reach for first because it's the most familiar fix we have.

### **The energy leaks nobody talks about**

Most fatigue conversations start and end with sleep hygiene. Blackout curtains. No screens before bed. A consistent wake time. All useful, none of it wrong, but often incomplete. There are quieter energy leaks that rarely make it into the conversation, and they tend to matter more than people expect.

Dehydration is a surprisingly common one. A two percent drop in body water is enough to measurably affect concentration and mood, long before you'd ever feel thirsty enough to notice. Most people walk around mildly dehydrated most of the day without realizing it, especially if coffee is doing double duty as their main fluid intake.

Micronutrient gaps are another quiet culprit. Iron, magnesium, and B12 all play direct roles in how your cells produce energy, and deficiencies in any of them can produce a fatigue that feels identical to plain old sleep debt. The frustrating part is that these deficiencies rarely show up as anything dramatic. They just make everything feel slightly heavier than it should.

Then there's the emotional cost of decision fatigue, which almost never gets named for what it is. Every small choice throughout the day, what to eat, what to answer first, whether to respond to that message now or later, draws from the same limited pool of mental energy. By evening, that pool can run dry long before your body is actually ready for sleep, which is part of why so many people feel simultaneously wired and exhausted at night.

### **What your body might actually be asking for**

If sleep alone hasn't fixed the exhaustion, it's worth asking a few different questions instead of just sleeping more.

Are you eating enough protein at breakfast? A meal heavy in refined carbohydrates and light on protein tends to produce a blood sugar spike followed by a crash, and that crash often masquerades as tiredness rather than what it actually is.

Are you getting outside during daylight hours, even briefly? Natural light exposure early in the day helps regulate your circadian rhythm in a way that artificial light simply can't replicate, and a disrupted rhythm can leave you feeling foggy even after a technically adequate night of sleep.

Are you moving your body at all, or has movement quietly disappeared from your day? It sounds counterintuitive, but low activity often produces more fatigue than moderate activity does. The body seems to interpret prolonged stillness as a signal to conserve energy, which paradoxically makes you feel like you have less of it.

Are you carrying unprocessed stress? Chronic low-grade stress keeps cortisol elevated for longer than it's meant to be, and that sustained elevation is deeply taxing on the body's energy systems, even when nothing about your day looks especially stressful on paper.

### **A different way to think about rest**

Rest is often treated as a single category, as if sleep is the only currency that counts. But there are at least a few different kinds of rest that operate somewhat independently of each other. Physical rest, the kind sleep provides. Mental rest, the kind that comes from stepping away from constant decision-making and input. Emotional rest, the

kind that comes from feeling genuinely understood rather than performing okayness for the people around you. Sensory rest, the kind that comes from stepping away from screens, noise, and overstimulation, even for short stretches.

Chronic fatigue often points to a deficit in one of these categories that more sleep simply can't resolve, because sleep was never the missing ingredient in the first place. Someone who is mentally and emotionally depleted can sleep a full eight hours and still wake up exhausted, not because the sleep failed, but because it was never solving the actual problem.

### **Where to start, realistically**

None of this requires an overhaul. Start by tracking, even loosely, when your energy dips during the day and what tends to precede it. Patterns tend to reveal themselves faster than people expect once they're actually looking for them.

Try adding protein to your first meal of the day for a week and notice whether your early afternoon crash softens at all. Try stepping outside for ten minutes within an hour of waking, no phone, just light. Try naming one form of rest you haven't given yourself in a while, and giving yourself permission to take it without earning it first.

Persistent fatigue that doesn't respond to any of this is worth bringing to a doctor, since it can sometimes point to something that needs proper medical attention rather than a lifestyle adjustment. Thyroid issues, anemia, and sleep disorders like apnea can all present as ordinary tiredness for a long time before anyone thinks to test for them, and there's no harm in ruling those out early rather than assuming it's just a busy season of life.

### **The habit that tends to matter more than people expect**

If there's one small habit worth building before any of the others, it's a short buffer between stopping work and starting sleep. Most people go from screens and stimulation directly into trying to fall asleep, and the body simply isn't built to shift that quickly. A twenty minute buffer, even something as simple as sitting somewhere dim without a phone, gives your nervous system a chance to downshift before you ask it to switch off entirely.

This matters more than an extra hour of sleep in a lot of cases, because sleep quality tends to matter more than sleep quantity once you're already getting a reasonable amount. Eight hours of restless, shallow sleep will leave you more tired than seven hours of sleep that actually reaches its deeper stages, and that buffer window is often the difference between the two.

### **Give yourself permission to investigate, not just endure**

So much of the advice around fatigue assumes the answer is always more sleep, more discipline, more willpower to push through. But your body is not being difficult for no reason. Fatigue is information, not a character flaw, and it's worth treating it that way instead of just trying to sleep your way out of a problem sleep alone might not solve. The goal isn't to optimize every hour of your day. It's to get curious about what your energy has actually been trying to tell you, and to start there instead of somewhere generic.

## Sample 2: Direct Response E-Commerce Copy

### Meadow & Root: Vitamin C Brightening Serum

#### **Your skin remembers everything. This helps it let go.**

Every late night, every stressful deadline, every afternoon you forgot sunscreen because you were only running to the car. Your skin keeps score, quietly, in the form of dullness that no amount of concealer fully hides and a texture that used to feel smoother than it does now.

Meadow & Root's Brightening Serum was built for exactly this. Not a miracle. Not an overnight fix promised by a label that knows you'll be disappointed by morning. Just a genuinely well-formulated 15% vitamin C serum, stabilized properly so it actually works instead of oxidizing into uselessness three weeks after you open the bottle, which is the quiet failure of most vitamin C products on the shelf.

#### **What makes this one different**

Most vitamin C serums lose their potency embarrassingly fast. L-ascorbic acid, the most effective form of vitamin C for skin, is notoriously unstable, and a lot of brands simply don't invest in the packaging or formulation needed to keep it working. You end up paying full price for a product that's basically water by the time you're halfway through the bottle.

We formulated this serum in an airless, opaque pump specifically to protect against oxidation, and we stabilized it with ferulic acid, which extends potency significantly and boosts the antioxidant effect at the same time. What you put on your skin in week six is just as active as what you put on in week one. That shouldn't be a luxury. It should be the baseline, and yet so few brands actually deliver it.

#### **What it actually does**

Vitamin C works primarily as an antioxidant, which means it helps neutralize the free radical damage caused by sun exposure, pollution, and everyday environmental stress before that damage has a chance to show up as fine lines and uneven tone down the road. It also plays a direct role in collagen synthesis, supporting the skin's natural structure over time rather than faking firmness with a temporary plumping agent that disappears by the next wash.

Most people notice a visible brightness within the first two to three weeks, a kind of glow that isn't just about hydration but about tone becoming genuinely more even. Dark spots and post-breakout marks tend to fade more noticeably over six to eight weeks of consistent use. This isn't an instant serum. It's a patient one, and patient tends to outperform instant in nearly every case that actually matters for your skin long term.

#### **How to use it**

Apply three to four drops to clean, dry skin each morning, before moisturizer and always before sunscreen. Vitamin C and SPF work beautifully together, since the antioxidant protection complements what sunscreen already does rather than replacing it. A little goes a long way here, so resist the urge to overapply. Your skin will thank you, and so will the bottle, which will actually last the full three months it's meant to.

If you're new to vitamin C, ease in with three to four applications a week before moving to daily use, just to let your skin adjust to the acidity. Some initial tingling is normal and usually settles within the first week or two. Persistent irritation is not normal, and if that happens, it's worth pausing and checking in with a dermatologist rather than pushing through.

#### **What people are noticing**

Customers consistently mention two things: the texture, which absorbs quickly without the sticky residue so many vitamin C serums leave behind, and the fact that it doesn't smell like it's already gone bad the way some natural formulations tend to a few weeks in. That's the ferulic acid and stable packaging doing their job, quietly, the way good formulation should.

### **A serum that respects your time**

You don't need a twelve step routine to see results. You need one product that's formulated correctly, used consistently, and honest about what it can and can't do. Meadow & Root's Brightening Serum won't erase a decade overnight. It will, with consistent use, help your skin look like it's had a little more rest than it's actually gotten, which might be the closest thing to magic that skincare can honestly offer.

Your skin has been carrying a lot. Give it something that actually works with it, not against it.

### **What's inside, and why it's there**

Beyond the 15% stabilized L-ascorbic acid and ferulic acid, we included vitamin E, which works synergistically with vitamin C to extend its antioxidant power even further. We left out synthetic fragrance entirely, not because fragrance is inherently bad, but because it offers zero benefit to the skin and only raises the odds of irritation for sensitive users. Every ingredient in this bottle earns its place. Nothing is filler, and nothing is there just to make the label look longer.

### **Who this is for**

This serum works well for most skin types, including sensitive skin once properly introduced, but it's a particularly good fit if you're dealing with dullness, uneven tone, early fine lines, or the lingering marks left behind by old breakouts. If your main concern is active acne rather than the marks it leaves behind, this can still be part of your routine, but it's worth pairing it with a dedicated treatment for the acne itself rather than expecting vitamin C to do that job alone.

### **A note on patience**

We won't pretend this works overnight, because it doesn't, and any brand telling you otherwise is either exaggerating or selling you something that won't last. Good skincare is closer to a relationship than a transaction. It asks for consistency, rewards patience, and tends to disappoint anyone looking for a quick fix over a real one. Give it eight weeks of honest, consistent use before deciding whether it's working. Most people don't make it past week three before they're already glad they stayed.

**Shop the Brightening Serum, \$48, free shipping over \$60.**

## Sample 3: Brand Story / About Page Copy

### About Hollow & Hearth

#### **We started this because the coffee near us kept letting us down, one cup at a time.**

Hollow & Hearth began the way most honest small businesses do, out of mild frustration and a stubborn refusal to settle. Our founder, a former line cook with more opinions about roast curves than was probably healthy, spent years driving forty minutes out of his way for a decent cup of coffee, because nothing closer ever tasted like it had been made by someone who actually cared.

So he started roasting in a garage. Badly, at first. There were burnt batches, uneven roasts, and more than one pot of coffee that ended up down the drain rather than in a cup. But something about the process kept pulling him back, the same way a good recipe does when you know it's close but not quite there yet. Eventually, close became right, and right became something worth sharing with more than just the neighbors who'd started showing up on Saturday mornings.

#### **What we actually believe about coffee**

We think coffee should taste like where it came from, not like a formula designed to taste the same in every bag regardless of origin. That means we roast in small batches, usually no more than twenty pounds at a time, so we can actually taste the difference between this month's beans and last month's, and adjust accordingly instead of running the same profile on autopilot.

We buy directly from farms whenever we can, not because it makes for a nice story on a bag, though it does, but because it lets us pay growers fairly and know exactly where our beans are coming from. Right now that means a small farm in the highlands of Huila, Colombia, and a cooperative in Yirgacheffe, Ethiopia, both relationships we've built slowly, over actual conversations rather than a single transactional order.

We also believe coffee shouldn't be complicated to enjoy. You don't need to know the difference between a washed and natural process to appreciate a genuinely good cup, though we're always happy to talk your ear off about it if you're curious. Good coffee should just taste like someone paid attention, at every step, long before it ever reached your mug.

#### **What's changed, and what hasn't**

We've grown a lot since the garage days. We have an actual roastery now, with equipment that doesn't threaten to catch fire every third batch, and a small team of people who care about this as much as our founder does, which honestly still surprises him some days. We ship nationwide, which felt like an impossible milestone back when the whole operation fit in a two car garage with room to spare.

What hasn't changed is the standard. Every batch still gets cupped, tasted, and adjusted before it goes out the door. If it's not right, it doesn't ship, even if that means telling a wholesale customer their order is running a day late because the roast didn't taste the way it should have. We'd rather be a little slower and a lot more honest than fast and forgettable.

#### **Why the name**

Hollow & Hearth comes from something our founder's grandmother used to say, that a house isn't a home until there's something warm in it. A hearth needs to be filled to mean anything, the same way a morning can feel a little hollow until there's a good cup of coffee in your hands to fill it. It stuck, mostly because it was true, and partly because everything else we tried sounded like it belonged to twelve other coffee brands already.

#### **Where we're headed**

We're not trying to become the biggest name in coffee. We're trying to stay the kind of company that still tastes every batch before it ships, that still knows the names of the farms our beans come from, and that still remembers

what it felt like to drive forty minutes just to find a decent cup. If we ever stop caring about that, we'd rather close the roastery than keep the name.

Thanks for being here. Pull up a chair. The coffee's on.

### **How we roast**

Every batch goes through the same disciplined process, regardless of size. Green beans arrive, get weighed and logged, and sit for a short rest period before roasting so the moisture content evens out. Our roaster tracks the curve manually rather than relying entirely on presets, because two bags of the same origin can behave differently depending on humidity, altitude at harvest, and even how long they sat in transit. A recipe that ignores those differences ends up flattening exactly what made the beans interesting in the first place.

Once roasted, every batch rests for a minimum of twenty four hours before we cup it, tasting it black, no sugar, no cream, nothing to hide behind. If it doesn't hit the notes we're expecting, based on notes taken directly from the farm about what that lot should taste like, it gets set aside and reroasted or, occasionally, scrapped entirely. We'd rather eat the cost of a bad batch than ship something that doesn't represent the farm fairly.

### **The people behind the beans**

We've visited both of our primary growing partners in person, which matters more to us than it might sound. It's one thing to buy coffee through a distributor and call it ethically sourced. It's another to sit at a table with the people who grew it, understand what a fair price actually means to their household, and build a relationship that outlasts a single harvest season. Those trips changed how we think about this business entirely, and they're part of why we've stayed small enough to keep making them.

### **Community, not just customers**

We host a cupping night on the first Saturday of every month, where anyone can come taste through our current lineup, ask questions, and tell us honestly what they think, including when they think we got something wrong. Some of our best roast adjustments have come directly out of those conversations. This has never been a business we wanted to run from behind a counter. We wanted a place people actually gathered, the way a good hearth was always meant to work.

**Shop our current roasts, or subscribe for a bag delivered fresh every month.**